Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **COMESA, World Bank Back Regional Drive to Connect 180 Million People Through Digital Inclusion** — Efficacy News, 3 November 2026 ZAMBIA EAST AFRICA SOUTHERN AFRICA

  COMESA and the World Bank held a validation workshop for the IDEA digital inclusion programme in Chongwe, Zambia, from 3 to 5 November 2026. Participants reviewed a draft regional digital inclusion strategy and action plan. The programme has an indicated envelope of about US$2.48 billion and aims to connect some 180 million people. *Also under Regional collaboration, Digital divides and Connectivity.*

- **Call for Inputs: Draft Continental Study on Digital Violence Against Women in Africa** — African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights, 3 November 2026 AFRICA

  The African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights published its draft Continental Study on Digital Violence Against Women in Africa for stakeholder review. The study covers 20 countries and finds that none has enacted comprehensive gender-responsive legislation on digital violence against women. Inputs are due by 4 December 2026, and an online consultation is set for 11 November. *Also under Regional collaboration and Cybersecurity.*

- **Africa's AI ambitions depend on stronger digital public infrastructure, expert says** — Biometric Update, 3 November 2026 CAMEROON AFRICA

  In an interview with Biometric Update, Cameroonian AI-governance lawyer Remy Takang argued that African governments should build reliable digital public infrastructure before drafting national AI strategies. He called for a rights-based framework for high-impact AI systems, with a right to redress. He argued that amending existing sector laws could serve in place of a single comprehensive AI law. *Also under AI and Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

Legislation and regulation

- **مصر تعتزم إصدار قانون خاص بالذكاء الاصطناعى لتنظيم استخداماته وحوكمته** — Youm7, 3 November 2026 EGYPT

  Youm7 reported that Egypt is in the final drafting stage of a dedicated law to regulate AI applications and their governance. The report names no official as its source. AI is governed at present under existing laws, including the Personal Data Protection Law 151 of 2020, cybercrime law 175 of 2018 and a 2022 fintech law. *Also under AI.*

- **No new Ghana Cards required under biometric verification law – NIA** — MyJoyOnline, 3 November 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's National Identification Authority said on 2 November 2026 that L.I. 2523 requires no new Ghana Cards or fresh biometric registration. The regulation extends mandatory biometric checks to private deals such as land sales and bars photocopying or visual inspection of the card. An NIA mobile app will give individuals a yes-or-no check. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS.*

- **JONAH ANDRIANANTOANINA - « Le secteur du numérique doit changer d'échelle »** — L'Express de Madagascar, 3 November 2026 MADAGASCAR

  Economist Jonah Andrianantoanina of the CREM think tank said Madagascar's 2005 digital-sector law is obsolete. He backed bill 040/2026 on electronic communications and digital infrastructure, filed in late August 2026. He projected that it and related reforms could add about MGA 4,000 billion to GDP and 330,000 digital jobs by 2031. *Also under Connectivity and AI.*

- **ICASA takes aim at dormant telecoms licences** — ITWeb South Africa, 3 November 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  South Africa's regulator ICASA published a Discussion Document on 30 October 2026 in its inquiry into individual network service licences. It found most of its 470 such licences dormant and proposes that new operators apply to it directly instead of buying existing ones. It is weighing a use-it-or-lose-it rule; comments are due within 45 working days. *Also under Connectivity and ICT Industry.*

- **Fake SIMS hold SA to ransom** — The Citizen, 3 November 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  In The Citizen, Johan van Graan argued that SIM cards registered in bulk to false identities hamper police work on ransom kidnappings. Justice Minister Mmamoloko Kubayi promised tougher RICA enforcement from 1 July 2026; by 9 October no results had been reported, he wrote. He cites 27 SIM-crime investigations since 2020, with one arrest. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS.*

Data protection

- **Monnaie électronique dans l'Uemoa : le passage obligatoire à la PI-SPI sème la confusion chez les usagers** — PressAfrik, 3 November 2026 WEST AFRICA

  PressAfrik reported failed bank-to-wallet transfers as mandatory PI-SPI routing began on 2 November 2026; the Launch Base Africa entry covers the rollout. Economist Souleymane Astou Diagne said coverage is incomplete, as microfinance has until 30 June 2027 to connect. He named fraud, platform outages and state use of payment data as risks. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech and Public debate and participation in policymaking.*

- **Government of Sierra Leone's Advanced Spectrum Monitoring System may violate privacy rights and carry risks that outweigh technical merits** — Sierra Leone Telegraph, 3 November 2026 SIERRA LEONE

  In an opinion piece, lawyer Joseph Fitzgerald Kamara argued that Sierra Leone's new spectrum monitoring system can locate transmitters and so could serve surveillance. Sierra Leone has no data protection law in force and no independent privacy regulator, he noted. He called for that law, judicial warrants, parliamentary oversight and donor conditions. *Also under Connectivity.*

Regional collaboration

- **Finances : La BCEAO se dote d'un nouveau systeme de paiement instantane** — Agence Nigerienne de Presse, 3 November 2026 WEST AFRICA

  Agence Nigérienne de Presse relayed a BCEAO statement of 2 November 2026 on mandatory PI-SPI routing; the Launch Base Africa entry covers the rollout. It sets a FCFA 100 million ceiling on instant business-to-business payments, which banks may lower. The same rules are to cover cross-border WAEMU transfers from 1 June 2027. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech.*

- **ECOWAS STRENGTHENS THE HARMONIZATION OF MONETARY AND FINANCIAL STATISTICS TO SUPPORT REGIONAL ECONOMIC INTEGRATION** — ECOWAS, 3 November 2026 WEST AFRICA

The ECOWAS Commission and the West African Monetary Agency opened an experts' meeting on monetary and financial statistics in Lomé on 2 November 2026. Central bank statisticians are reviewing a draft regional metadata framework until 7 November. They are also assessing a regional action plan adopted in January 2025. *Also under National statistics and Standards.*

- **Côte d'Ivoire and Gabon explore cooperation on AI and digital public services** — Tech Review Africa, 3 November 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE GABON

  Côte d'Ivoire's digital minister Djibril Ouattara and Gabon's Mark-Alexandre Doumba discussed cooperation on AI, digital public services and data infrastructure in Libreville. They met at the sixth session of the African Union's Specialised Technical Committee on Communication and ICT. The avenues named include reuse of public-service algorithms, cross-data backups and shared computing capacity. *Also under AI and Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **Cybersécurité : le Niger sollicite l'expérience du Burkina Faso pour son SOC national** — wearetech.africa, 3 November 2026 NIGER BURKINA FASO

  A Nigerien delegation led by Mohamed Ghadfi, deputy secretary-general of the communications ministry, visited Burkina Faso's information-security agency ANSSI-BF from 2 to 6 November 2026. The study mission prepares Niger's national Security Operations Centre. Niger's government created its Centre national de cybersécurité by decree in October 2025. *Also under Cybersecurity.*

- **Connecting Africa's wallets, unlocking Africa's trade, smartly** — Citi Newsroom, 3 November 2026 GHANA AFRICA

  Gabby Asare Otchere-Darko, chairman of the Africa Prosperity Network, argued in an opinion piece for linking Africa's mobile money wallets across borders. He made the case at the Africa Internet Governance Forum in Accra on 2 November 2026. The network estimates that this and visa-free travel could lift intra-African trade from 16% to over 25%. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech and Digital Identity and CRVS.*

- **Africa's $775bn savings pool trapped as cross-border finance stalls** — BusinessDay Nigeria, 3 November 2026 AFRICA

  The sixth African Financial Industry Barometer, presented in Luanda on 3 November 2026, found 11% of surveyed financial institutions connected to the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System and 45% with no plans to connect. Only 7% reported tangible progress under the AfCFTA. About 66% reported a rise in digital fraud, and 88% of banks and fintechs. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech and Cybersecurity.*

- **COMESA, World Bank Back Regional Drive to Connect 180 Million People Through Digital Inclusion** — Efficacy News, 3 November 2026 ZAMBIA EAST AFRICA SOUTHERN AFRICA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **Call for Inputs: Draft Continental Study on Digital Violence Against Women in Africa** — African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights, 3 November 2026 AFRICA

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Standards

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Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **Bawumia calls for laws to protect workers from AI job losses** — MyJoyOnline, 3 November 2026 GHANA

  Mahamudu Bawumia, flagbearer of Ghana's New Patriotic Party, called for laws to protect workers from job losses caused by AI. Speaking to the Trades Union Congress, he proposed that government, organised labour, employers and technology experts draft the rules together. He said the framework should provide for retraining and reskilling. *Also under AI.*

- **Monnaie électronique dans l'Uemoa : le passage obligatoire à la PI-SPI sème la confusion chez les usagers** — PressAfrik, 3 November 2026 WEST AFRICA

  Summarised under Data protection.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Bayobab East to West Connectivity Project: fibre laid** — TechAfrica, 3 November 2026 SOUTH SUDAN KENYA

  Bayobab, an MTN Group company, said on 22 October 2026 that civil works and fibre deployment are complete on the Kenya and South Sudan segments of Northern Route 1 of its East-to-West Connectivity Project. The segments carry 2,038km of fibre, and service activation is the next step. The company gave no activation date, customers or cost.

- **JONAH ANDRIANANTOANINA - « Le secteur du numérique doit changer d'échelle »** — L'Express de Madagascar, 3 November 2026 MADAGASCAR

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

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DPI

Data Exchange

- **Bénin : Wadagni concrétise sa promesse, le casier judiciaire instantané à 1 900 FCFA** — Linfodrome, 3 November 2026 BENIN

  Since 1 November 2026, Benin's Ministry of Justice and Legislation has issued the criminal-record certificate (bulletin n°3) instantly on service-public.bj, for 1,900 FCFA. The certificate is generated from the personal identification number (NPI) and civil-status data the administration already holds, with no supporting documents. Beninese citizens abroad can also apply. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and Digital Identity and CRVS.*

Digital Identity and CRVS

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Digital Payments and Fintech

- **West Africa's Unified Payments Network Is Off to a Rocky Start** — Launch Base Africa, 3 November 2026 SENEGAL CÔTE D'IVOIRE WEST AFRICA

  From 2 November 2026 the BCEAO required interoperable e-money transfers across WAEMU to route through its PI-SPI platform. In the first days, users in Senegal and Côte d'Ivoire reported Orange Money-to-Wave transfers debited but not credited, and alias conflicts. Wave added a 1% cash-withdrawal fee, outside the BCEAO's transfer-fee cap; the BCEAO had not commented.

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Registries

- **Gender Ministry swears in Data Review Committee to strengthen household registry** — MyJoyOnline, 3 November 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection swore in a Data Review Committee for the Ghana National Household Registry. The committee will review and validate the registry's analytical reports before they go to stakeholders and the public. The registry holds about three million enrolled households across all 16 regions. *Also under Sectoral management information systems.*

Sectoral management information systems

- **Gender Ministry swears in Data Review Committee to strengthen household registry** — MyJoyOnline, 3 November 2026 GHANA

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Other GovTech and e-Gov

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Technology

AI

- **Former AfDB president Adesina proposes $10bn AI fund to anchor $50bn investment drive across Africa** — BusinessDay Nigeria, 3 November 2026 NIGERIA AFRICA

  Former African Development Bank president Akinwumi Adesina proposed a $10 billion African AI fund to anchor $50 billion of investment over ten years. He spoke at the 2026 Oxford Global Think Tank Leadership Conference. Nigeria's communications minister Bosun Tijani told the same conference that AI depends on connectivity, compute, data, skills and institutions. *Also under Digital sovereignty.*

- **Bawumia calls for laws to protect workers from AI job losses** — MyJoyOnline, 3 November 2026 GHANA

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ICT Industry

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Inclusion

Access to services

- **Group raises alarm over digital exclusion in pastoralist counties** — The Standard, 3 November 2026 KENYA

  The Grassroots Disability Agenda launched a survey report in Nairobi on digital exclusion of persons with disabilities in Garissa, Kajiado and Marsabit counties. It cites device and data costs, inaccessible services, limited skills, online safety risks and weak policy implementation. The report sets out ten policy actions for government, regulators and technology providers. *Also under Digital divides.*

Digital divides

- **Group raises alarm over digital exclusion in pastoralist counties** — The Standard, 3 November 2026 KENYA

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Data

National statistics

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Geopolitics

Digital sovereignty

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country and region news.